

Process Mapping Canvas

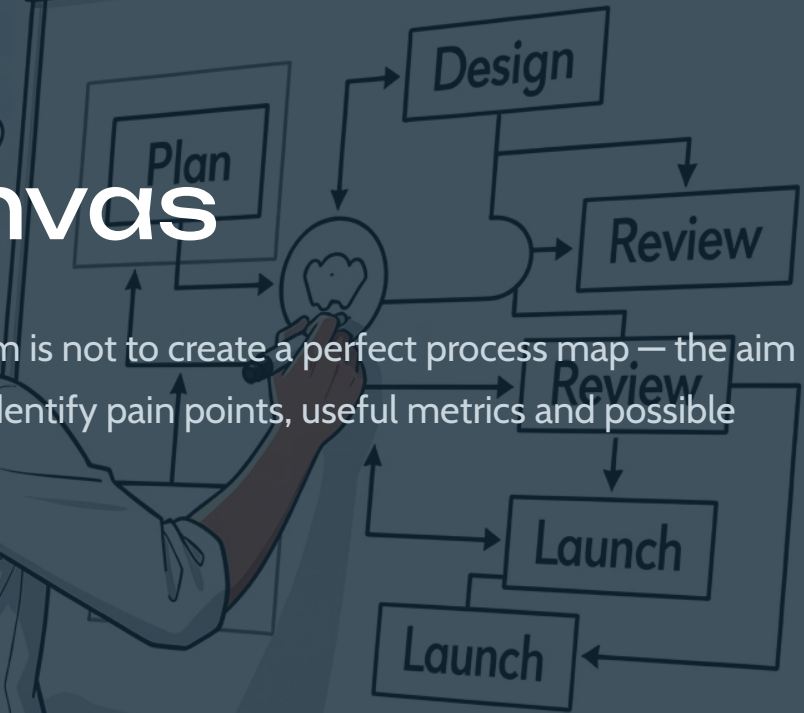
Use this canvas to capture a process at a practical discovery level. The aim is not to create a perfect process map — the aim is to create a **shared view of how the work happens today** so the team can identify pain points, useful metrics and possible automation opportunities.

TEMPLATE

PROCESS DISCOVERY

AUTOMATION READINESS

Map the work. Measure the pain. Automate with purpose.



How to Use This Canvas

Follow these steps in order. Start with the normal path and build outward. A useful map is better than a perfect map.

O1

Start with the normal path

Capture the trigger, outcome, main steps, roles and systems first.

O2

Add complexity

Layer in decision points, handoffs and exceptions once the core path is clear.

O3

Identify pain

Capture known pain points, delays, rework and risk areas.

O4

Gather evidence

Record any known metrics or evidence. Estimates are acceptable — mark them clearly.

O5

Decide the next action

Use the output to support the scenario clinic or automation opportunity assessment.

When to use this canvas

- A process may be a candidate for automation
- The process is not clearly understood end to end
- Different people describe the process differently
- Multiple teams, systems or handoffs are involved
- The team needs to identify where pain, delay, rework or risk exists
- The team needs to decide whether to automate, improve, investigate or defer

What this canvas is not

This canvas is not intended to produce a final automation design. It is a discovery tool — designed to help the team understand the current process, make the pain visible, and decide the next best action.



A useful map is better than a perfect map. Capture what you know today and flag what is missing.

1. Process Overview

Complete the fields below to establish the basic context for this process mapping session.

Process name	[PROCESS NAME]
Date captured	[DATE]
Captured by	[FACILITATOR / TEAM]
Process owner	[PROCESS OWNER]
Business area / team	[TEAM]
Current state or future state?	Current state
Purpose of mapping	[WHY ARE WE MAPPING THIS PROCESS?]

2. Process Summary

Short description

Describe the process in one or two sentences.

[Describe what this process does and why it exists.]

Why this process matters

Briefly describe why this process is important.

[Explain why this process matters.]

Why this process is being considered

Tick or note the reasons this process may be worth reviewing.

- ☐ Manual
- ☐ Repetitive
- ☐ Slow
- ☐ High-volume
- ☐ Risky
- ☐ Inconsistent
- ☐ Difficult to track
- ☐ Approval-heavy
- ☐ Spreadsheet-heavy
- ☐ Dependent on email handoffs
- ☐ Creates rework or duplication
- ☐ Poor user or customer experience
- ☐ Other: [OTHER REASON]

3. Process Boundaries

Define clearly where the process starts and ends before mapping the steps. This prevents scope creep and keeps the team focused.

Trigger	[WHAT STARTS THE PROCESS?]
Start point	[WHERE DOES THE PROCESS BEGIN?]
End point	[WHERE DOES THE PROCESS END?]
Desired outcome	[WHAT SHOULD BE ACHIEVED?]
Output / deliverable	[WHAT IS PRODUCED OR COMPLETED?]

Out of scope

Capture anything that is related but not part of this process map.

 [What is deliberately out of scope for this process map?]

4. People and Roles Involved

List the people, roles or teams involved in the process and what they do.

Role / team	What they do in the process	Notes
[ROLE / TEAM]	[RESPONSIBILITY]	[NOTES]
[ROLE / TEAM]	[RESPONSIBILITY]	[NOTES]
[ROLE / TEAM]	[RESPONSIBILITY]	[NOTES]
[ROLE / TEAM]	[RESPONSIBILITY]	[NOTES]

Key questions to ask

Who starts the process?

Who completes each step?

Who approves or reviews work?

Who receives the output?

Who experiences the pain if the process fails?

Who owns the process end to end?

5. Systems, Tools and Documents Used

List the tools, systems, forms, documents or channels used in the process. Identifying where information is captured, copied or re-entered is critical for spotting automation opportunities.

System / tool / document	How it is used	Notes
[SYSTEM / TOOL]	[HOW IT IS USED]	[NOTES]
[SYSTEM / TOOL]	[HOW IT IS USED]	[NOTES]
[SYSTEM / TOOL]	[HOW IT IS USED]	[NOTES]
[SYSTEM / TOOL]	[HOW IT IS USED]	[NOTES]

Common examples

- Email
- Spreadsheet
- Service desk tool
- Workflow tool
- Finance system
- HR system
- Identity system
- Shared drive
- Form
- Reporting dashboard
- Chat or messaging tool

Key questions to ask

- Where is information **captured**?
- Where is information **copied or re-entered**?
- Which systems are the **source of truth**?
- Which systems are used only for **tracking or coordination**?
- Are there any **manual workarounds**?

6. Current Process Steps

Capture the main process steps in order. Start with the normal path first. Add exceptions later in Section 10.

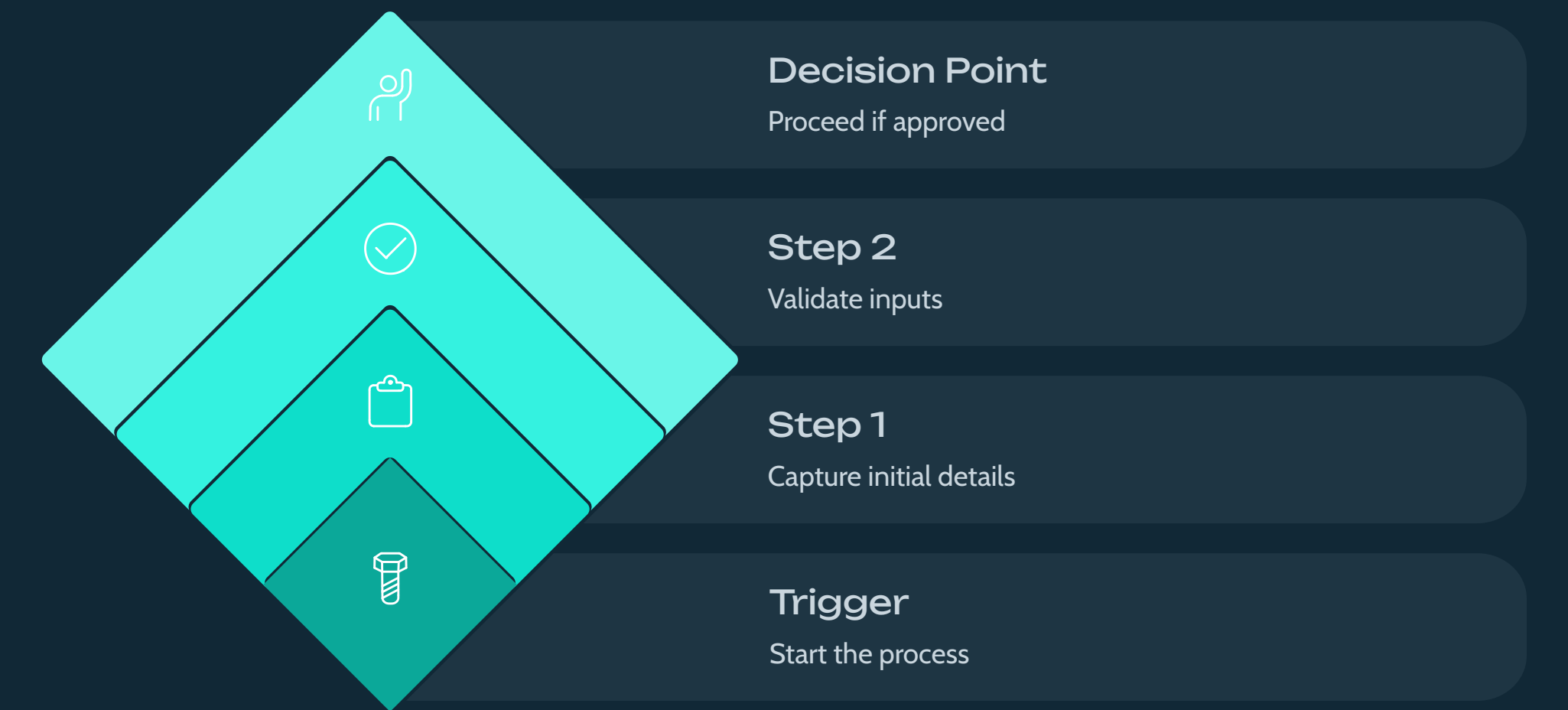
St ep	Description	Role / team	System / tool	Notes
1	[WHAT HAPPENS?]	[WHO DOES IT?]	[SYSTEM / TOOL]	[NOTES]
2	[WHAT HAPPENS?]	[WHO DOES IT?]	[SYSTEM / TOOL]	[NOTES]
3	[WHAT HAPPENS?]	[WHO DOES IT?]	[SYSTEM / TOOL]	[NOTES]
4	[WHAT HAPPENS?]	[WHO DOES IT?]	[SYSTEM / TOOL]	[NOTES]
5	[WHAT HAPPENS?]	[WHO DOES IT?]	[SYSTEM / TOOL]	[NOTES]
6	[WHAT HAPPENS?]	[WHO DOES IT?]	[SYSTEM / TOOL]	[NOTES]



Add more rows as needed. Aim to capture the full normal path before adding exceptions or variations.

7. Simple Process Flow

Use this section to sketch the process in a simple flow format. Fill in the trigger, steps, decision points and outcome below.



Trigger	[WHAT STARTS THE PROCESS?]
Step 1	[STEP 1]
Step 2	[STEP 2]
Decision point	[DECISION POINT] — Yes → [NEXT STEP] / No → [ALTERNATIVE STEP]
Step 3	[STEP 3]
Outcome	[OUTCOME]

8. Decisions, Approvals and Handoffs

Decisions and approvals

Capture key decision points and approvals in the process.

Decision / approval	Who makes it?	Criteria / rule	What happens next?
[DECISION]	[ROLE / TEAM]	[CRITERIA]	[NEXT STEP]
[DECISION]	[ROLE / TEAM]	[CRITERIA]	[NEXT STEP]
[DECISION]	[ROLE / TEAM]	[CRITERIA]	[NEXT STEP]

Key questions

- Where are decisions made?
- Are the rules clear and consistent?
- Are approvals required?
- Are approvals based on risk, value, policy or judgement?
- Are there decision points that could be standardised?

Handoffs

Capture where work moves between people, teams or systems.

Handoff	From	To	How?	Pain / risk
[HAND OFF]	[FROM]	[TO]	[EMAIL / SYSTEM / MEETING]	[PAIN OR RISK]
[HAND OFF]	[FROM]	[TO]	[EMAIL / SYSTEM / MEETING]	[PAIN OR RISK]
[HAND OFF]	[FROM]	[TO]	[EMAIL / SYSTEM / MEETING]	[PAIN OR RISK]

Key questions

- Where does work wait between people or teams?
- Where does information get lost or changed?
- Where do people chase updates?
- Which handoffs create the most delay or rework?

9. Exceptions, Variations and Pain Points

Exceptions and variations

Capture where the process does not follow the normal path.

Exception / variation	How often?	What causes it?	How is it handled today?
[EXCEPTION]	[FREQUENCY]	[CAUSE]	[CURRENT HANDLING]
[EXCEPTION]	[FREQUENCY]	[CAUSE]	[CURRENT HANDLING]
[EXCEPTION]	[FREQUENCY]	[CAUSE]	[CURRENT HANDLING]

 Could the standard path be automated while exceptions remain manual? This is a common and practical approach.

Pain points

Capture the main pain points in the process. Be specific about where they occur and who is affected.

Pain point	Where it occurs	Who is affected?	Impact
[PAIN POINT]	[STEP / HANDOFF / DECISION]	[WHO IS AFFECTED?]	[IMPACT]
[PAIN POINT]	[STEP / HANDOFF / DECISION]	[WHO IS AFFECTED?]	[IMPACT]
[PAIN POINT]	[STEP / HANDOFF / DECISION]	[WHO IS AFFECTED?]	[IMPACT]

Common pain point examples

Missing information	Manual data entry	Repeated status chasing	Long approval delays
Unclear ownership	Inconsistent decisions	Duplicate work	Poor visibility
Rework or corrections	High exception rates	User frustration	Operational risk

10. Known Metrics and Evidence

Capture any known data, estimates or evidence. **Estimates are acceptable at this stage** — mark them clearly as estimates. Partial evidence is better than no evidence.

Metric	Known value / estimate	Source	Confidence
Volume	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low
Cycle time	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low
Touch time	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low
Wait time	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low
Handoffs	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low
Rework / errors	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low
Exceptions	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low
Risk impact	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low
User impact	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low

 [Capture any useful notes about the evidence, assumptions or data quality.]

11. Missing Evidence

Capture what still needs to be validated before a confident decision can be made.

Missing evidence	Why it matters	Who can help?	Follow-up owner
[MISSING EVIDENCE]	[WHY IT MATTERS]	[PERSON / TEAM]	[OWNER]
[MISSING EVIDENCE]	[WHY IT MATTERS]	[PERSON / TEAM]	[OWNER]
[MISSING EVIDENCE]	[WHY IT MATTERS]	[PERSON / TEAM]	[OWNER]

Common missing evidence examples

- Actual request volume
- Average cycle time and touch time
- Rework rate and exception frequency
- System integration options
- Process ownership confirmation

12. Initial Opportunity View

Based on the process map and available evidence, capture an initial view of the opportunity. This is a working assessment — not a final decision.

What is the main pain?	[RESPONSE]
Is the pain mainly effort, flow, quality, risk or user impact?	[RESPONSE]
Is automation likely to help?	Yes / No / Partially / Unknown
What might need to be improved before automation?	[RESPONSE]
What needs further investigation?	[RESPONSE]
What is the likely next best action?	[RESPONSE]

13. Initial Category

Select the category that best describes the current state of the opportunity.

Automate now

High value, feasible and ready. The process is stable, well understood and the case for automation is clear.

Improve first

Worth solving, but the process needs tidying before automation will deliver value.

Investigate further

Potential value exists, but more evidence is needed before a confident decision can be made.

Do not automate yet

Low value, unstable or unclear. Defer until the process or business case is better understood.

Rationale: [Explain why this category was selected.]

14. Next Best Action and Summary

Next best action

Capture the agreed next best action and assign clear ownership.

Action	Owner	Due date	Notes
[NEXT ACTION]	[OWNER]	[DATE]	[NOTES]
[NEXT ACTION]	[OWNER]	[DATE]	[NOTES]
[NEXT ACTION]	[OWNER]	[DATE]	[NOTES]

Summary

Process	[PROCESS NAME]
Main pain	[SUMMARY]
Known evidence	[SUMMARY]
Missing evidence	[SUMMARY]
Likely response	Automation / improvement / both / investigate further / defer
Initial category	Automate now / improve first / investigate further / do not automate yet
Next best action	[SUMMARY]

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